CAYQUE GASTÓN CICARELLI

Video Game Developer | Unity (C#) • Godot (GDScript) • Ren'Py (Python)

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SUMMARY

Video game developer and Computer Science graduate, freelancing for a US studio: Lead Programmer of a Unity 6/C# 3D horror game released free on itch.io (about 11,400 lines of C#), and sole developer of a commercial Ren'Py/Python game built for Windows, macOS, Linux and Android (504 of 541 commits); also programmed in GDScript on a Godot co-op game on Steam. Fluent English, used daily at work.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Programmer (Freelance) — Letterflux Studios (US) | Remote | Sep 2026 – Present
SPECTOR: 3D narrative horror game in Unity 6 (C#, URP) and Naninovel for the Spooktober Visual Novel Jam 2026: a streamer runs a live Ouija session with simulated chat and 7 endings. Made with an international team; released free on itch.io. letterfluxstudios.itch.io/spector

- Developed about 11,400 lines of C# in 107 scripts, integrating Naninovel into an interactive 3D scene via about 40 custom commands.
- Wrote enum-based state machines for zombies, mystery box, turret, player sit/stand and a 7-state cockroach; structured the story flow as Naninovel labels and global variables.
- Structured the code around Unity components: MonoBehaviours, prefabs, [RequireComponent], an abstract Interactable base class for raycast interaction, and an IShootable interface.
- Programmed enemy AI with NavMesh: zombies rise, chase, attack and become crawlers after explosions, with a round system; used the Playables API for crossfades matched to NavMeshAgent speed.
- Programmed an FPS minigame in the style of CoD Zombies: 20 weapons with ADS, physics grenades, rockets, explosions with distance damage and line-of-sight checks, decals via MaterialPropertyBlock.
- Managed scenes with additive loading of the easter-egg scene (sealed only when off-screen, via frustum test) and unloading with asset cleanup; reloaded the scene to reset the room, fixing Naninovel's URP camera stack.
- Implemented input with the Input System (keyboard and gamepad) and a pose-based camera; resolved input conflicts between the Konami Code and the VN engine; built save, load and rollback with custom IStatefulService services.
- Programmed procedural cursive handwriting (Catmull-Rom splines, quill thickness), a data-driven simulated live chat, a scare director, UI shaders (chroma key, glitch), and an Editor tool that renders the intro to video via ffmpeg.

Lead Developer (Freelance) — Letterflux Studios (US) | Remote | Mar 2026 – Present
A Week to Remember: Ren'Py visual novel in alpha, nearly 500 wishlists, release planned for 2027. store.steampowered.com/app/5056570

- Sole developer on a 10-person team, mostly artists; share the game design with the director; made 504 of 541 commits (93%).
- Did the full software engineering before coding and restructured the code to avoid an unsustainable monolith, keeping it maintainable.
- Designed and built branching choices with affinity checks (5 endings so far, structured for 20+) and a state-machine-like flow for exploration, dialogue, minigames and spellcasting.
- Built a spellcasting minigame with custom spring-damper physics; prototyped the minigames and tested them extensively first.
- Built full controller support to Steam's criterion (focus navigation, virtual cursor, live remapping, brand detection by GUID); found 8 undocumented engine behaviors by reading Ren'Py's source.
- Built the release pipeline for Windows, macOS, Linux and Android (SteamPipe, Steam Cloud, Steam Deck Verified audit); optimized the desktop game for mobile and fixed an Android accelerometer bug.
- Built sandboxes and a menu positioner so the director and artists adjust content without code.
- Wrote C# tools, compiled via PowerShell, that calibrate object positions in 4000×2250 backgrounds by template matching.
- Built automated QA (asserts, UI pixel-diff, a 735-asset-path scan); ran itch.io playtests (150+ downloads) and fixed the bugs found.
- Write the docs (9-page GDD, extensive README, system docs) and manage the Git branching workflow with pull requests (Scrum).

Information Security Intern — Edenred Brasil | São Paulo, Brazil | Mar 2024 – Dec 2025

- Identified a critical data leak from transfer-log patterns in Splunk (SPL); worked on 100+ incidents in Proofpoint DLP.

Ruby on Rails Developer — Sankhya Jiva | Remote | Aug 2022 – May 2023

- Maintained and extended the company's main legacy web app (Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, SQL), shipping new features.

PROJECTS

The New Year's School — Developer | Godot (GDScript) | Steam | Feb 2026

- Programmed basic choice systems, network security and translations in GDScript for a co-op multiplayer game; fixed bugs.

SKILLS

- **Engines:** Unity 6 (URP, Input System, NavMesh, Playables), Godot (project organization, game logic, security), Ren'Py, Naninovel.
- **Programming:** C# (Unity, .NET tools), GDScript (Godot), Python (Ren'Py), PowerShell, JavaScript, SQL, Ruby on Rails.
- **Game Architecture:** state machines, component-based design, scene management, input handling, enemy AI (NavMesh).
- **Platforms & Release:** Windows, macOS, Linux, Android, Steam Deck; Steamworks (SteamPipe, Steam Cloud); itch.io.
- **Debugging & Process:** debugging, automated QA, playtesting; Git branching + pull requests, Scrum, prototyping, GDDs.
- **Languages:** English (fluent), Portuguese (native), Spanish (intermediate).

EDUCATION

B.Sc. in Computer Science — Centro Universitário FEI, Dec 2025 | Capstone: AI algorithm to identify a specific type of deepfake